

The Program in Action

When you run *jaccuse.py*, the output will look like this:

```
J'ACCUSE! (a mystery game)
--snip--
Time left: 5 min, 0 sec
  You are in your TAXI. Where do you want to go?
(A)LBINO ALLIGATOR PIT
(B)OWLING ALLEY
(C)ITY HALL
(D)UCK POND
(H)IPSTER CAFE
(O)LD BARN
(U)NIVERSITY LIBRARY
(V)IDEO GAME MUSEUM
(Z)OO
> a

Time left: 4 min, 48 sec
  You are at the ALBINO ALLIGATOR PIT.
  ESPRESSA TOFFEEPOT with the ONE COWBOY BOOT is here.

(J) "J'ACCUSE!" (3 accusations left)
(Z) Ask if they know where ZOPHIE THE CAT is.
(T) Go back to the TAXI.
(1) Ask about ESPRESSA TOFFEEPOT
(2) Ask about ONE COWBOY BOOT
> z
  They give you this clue: "DUKE HAUTDOG"
Press Enter to continue...
--snip--
```

How It Works

To fully understand this program, you should pay close attention to the clues dictionary, which is set up on lines 51 to 109. You can uncomment lines 151 to 154 to display it on the screen. This dictionary has strings from the SUSPECTS list for the keys and “clue dictionaries” for the values. Each of these clue dictionaries contains strings from SUSPECTS and ITEMS. The original suspect will answer with these strings when asked about another suspect or item. For example, if clues['DUKE HAUTDOG']['CANDLESTICK'] is set to 'DUCK POND', then when the player asks Duke Hautdog about the Candlestick, they'll say it is at the Duck Pond. The suspects, items, locations, and culprit get shuffled each time the game is played.

The code for this program revolves around this data structure, so understanding it is necessary to unlocking your understanding of the rest of the program.

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1. ""J'ACCUSE!, by Al Sweigart al@inventwithpython.com
 2. A mystery game of intrigue and a missing cat.
 3. View this code at <https://nostarch.com/big-book-small-python-projects>